



Camera Phone

Shooting for the stars

Smartphone photography is a test of how well a company can tune a particular lens and make it work with their algorithm. Computational photography has improved smartphone photography drastically in the past few years, and 2022 was no different. We saw the widespread use of features such as OIS (including some phones with Gimbal OIS), higher optical zoom levels, and increased use of AI algorithms in smartphone photography and videography. While the Samsungs and Apples of the world stayed strong, we saw fantastic offerings from the likes of Xiaomi, vivo, and others that challenged them. And one of these did just enough to be crowned the Digit Zero1 Award winner...

Winner: vivo X80 Pro

The vivo x Zeiss collaboration continued this year and the vivo X80 Pro is the fourth phone born out of this partnership. The phone's primary camera takes the absolute best pictures in 2022; rich in detail and with great colour accuracy using the Zeiss Natural Colour Mode 2.0. The HDR processing is fantastic as well and regardless of the environment, the phone managed to snap a gorgeous shot with great dynamic range. As per our testing, it is the best point-and-shoot camera in 2022. In low light, the vivo X80 Pro took some of the most detailed shots

with minimal lens flare and noise and heaps of detail. Gimbal stabilisation on the telephoto lens works wonders for hand-held performance and the periscope lens is decent as well. 4K videos taken on the vivo X80 Pro had impressive stabilisation and looked crisp, however, 8K videos looked great but the motion is a bit more jerky. Overall though, this is the absolute best camera on a smartphone in 2022!

Runner Up: iPhone 14 Pro Max

Apple shook things up with the iPhone 14 Pro and Pro Max, offering a higher resolution 48 MP main sensor for the very first time. You get pixel binned 12 MP photos unless you go ProRAW to capture full 48 MP shots. The phone features 3x optical zoom like last year, but this time around, there's a novel 2x zoom option that crops into the high resolution 48 MP sensor to give you a

near optical zoom-level 2x shot – and while we were skeptical about the quality of this feature at first, it really convinced us with its superb performance. Apple's new Photonic Engine also makes its debut that promises enhanced colour and detail – and the photos are indeed packed with detail, and have good colour accuracy, but not as good as the vivo x80 Pro's colour accuracy. Nevertheless, the iPhone 14 Pro Max was defeated narrowly by the vivo X80 Pro but it has a fantastic and consistent camera system. It also has the absolute best video quality of any smartphone on the market right now.

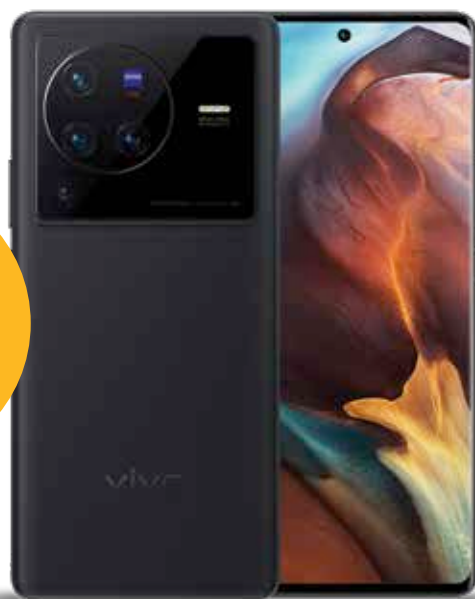
Best Buy: OPPO Reno8 Pro

For under ₹50K, the OPPO Reno8 Pro will give you vibrant and crisp pictures in daylight from its 50 MP primary lens. The lens also provides great natural background blur and good dynamic range in most scenarios. The phone also clicks solid portrait shots in ideal lighting conditions but the colour tone of subjects can be a bit unnatural at times. The 8 MP ultrawide lens is great in daylight, but suffers slightly in low-light. The 32 MP selfie camera is one of the best at this price range. This is a value-for-money camera phone that will click impressive images without burning a hole in your wallet.

– Dhriti Datta | dhriti@digit.in



vivo X80 Pro
Price: ₹79,999



iPhone 14 Pro Max
Price: ₹1,39,900

DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2022



OPPO Reno8 Pro
Price: ₹45,999